

Alejandro Tapia

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SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Zustand, Tailwind, HTML5, CSS

Backend: Python, FastAPI, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, REST API, RESTful API, Prisma, SQLAlchemy, Redis, Firebase, Azure, AWS, Git, Bash

AI and Machine Learning: Supervised Learning, Classification Models, Model Evaluation, Regression Analysis, Data Processing Pipelines, Cross Validation, NumPy, Pandas

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer

Stealth Startup

February 2024 - Present

- Built internal design system from scratch using React, enabling engineers to implement complex UI patterns 40% faster through composable, accessible components. Reduced feedback integration time from days to hours, allowing the team to align on prototypes within 1–2 working sessions instead of full sprint cycles.
- Integrated AI search functionality using OpenAI GPT-4o API and Elasticsearch, enabling non-technical users to retrieve campaign insights while maintaining security through prompt sanitization and role-aware access controls.
- Implemented real-time analytics and custom filters into the dashboard, allowing stakeholders to monitor performance and user engagement metrics with greater precision and responsiveness.

Frontend Developer

Quorus

May 2023 - February 2024

- Led migration from Vue to Next.js, architecting a component library in TypeScript and Tailwind that increased UI consistency, reduced frontend maintenance effort, and improved page load performance by 15%.
- Leveraged unique approach rooted in cognitive science to build an investment dashboard, integrating continuous user feedback and aligning technical choices with how users process complex financial data under uncertainty, reducing cognitive friction and increasing clarity, trust, and decision confidence.
- Improved real-time data performance. optimized data retrieval, and minimized payload sizes, reducing API response times by 400ms and enhancing the user experience in dynamic scenarios, such as fluctuating stock prices.

Frontend Developer

Breakout LA

October 2022 - April 2023

- Accelerated product listing processes through deployed functionality for user product submissions, reducing time to market from up to 7 days to under 24 hours and boosting weekly product availability.
- Aligned platform branding and UI/UX in collaboration with the client and designer to create a visually cohesive, user-centered experience, cutting navigation-related support tickets by nearly 50%.
- Enhanced platform stability through rigorous testing protocols, simulating high-traffic conditions to identify and resolve potential issues before launch, increasing uptime by 40% during high-traffic product launches to improve reliability and user trust.

Python AI and ML Tutor

UCLA

June 2020 - September 2022

- Enhanced instruction on Python fundamentals and introductory machine learning concepts, including supervised learning, classification algorithms, model evaluation, and data manipulation, strengthening student understanding of AI-driven programming practices.
- Supported over 150 students through labs, discussions, and one-on-one mentoring, helping them master programming concepts and foundational machine learning topics such as regression analysis, cross-validation, and basic neural networks.
- Collaborated with faculty to design and align lesson plans focused on AI and algorithmic thinking, enhancing curriculum consistency and improving student ability to translate theoretical concepts into practical coding projects.

PROJECTS

Dog Adoption Platform

alex-tapia-fetch.netlify.app/

- Modern web app with secure auth, advanced filtering and search, and a custom matching algorithm. Built with feature-based architecture, atomic state via Zustand, and modern React patterns like custom hooks and conditional styling, using Next.js, clsx, tailwind-merge, and TypeScript.

Study Hub

studyhub-alejandro-tapia.netlify.app/

- Retro-themed study tool offering customizable music, ambient sounds, and visual themes to boost productivity and focus during study sessions, built with React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Vitest, and Framer Motion to inspire an immersive, enjoyable study environment for users.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Cognitive Science

University of California, Los Angeles • 2022